



Maana Living - Executive Pilot Assessment

Overall Pilot Score: 6.6/10 ▯ **CONDITIONAL PROCEED** (with strict guardrails)

Client Profile

Maana Living operates luxury short-term accommodations across Perth's premium Applecross market, managing **50+ properties** with a lean **4-person team**. Owner **Mabel Lim** ("Businesswoman of the Year") runs annual operations costing **\$200,000** in subscriptions and overhead, while facing chronic **late-night call burnout** and manual admin overload. Current tech stack includes **Akia** (guest messaging) and **Selene** (voice agent trial), but both require heavy manual Q&A input, creating rather than reducing workload.^{[1] [2]}

Critical Context:

- **Tech Literacy:** "Not techie at all" - relies on daughter for implementation
- **Decision Authority:** Split between owner (business) and daughter (tech)
- **Relationship:** Personal connection via your mum - double-edged sword
- **Engagement History:** Positive initial response ("asked to partner") → 3 weeks radio silence after multiple follow-ups

Competitive Comparison to Ideal Pilot Profile

Criteria	Maana Living	Ideal Pilot	Gap	Status
Pain Point Urgency	9/10	8/10	+1	✓
Budget Available	8/10	7/10	+1	✓
Decision Speed	3/10	7/10	-4	▯
Tech Readiness	4/10	6/10	-2	⚠
Engagement Quality	4/10	8/10	-4	▯
Competitive Threat	7/10	5/10	+2	⚠
Relationship Risk	6/10	2/10	+4	▯
Case Study Value	8/10	7/10	+1	✓

Red Flags: Decision Speed, Tech Readiness, Engagement Quality all below threshold.^[1]

Detailed Breakdown

✔ STRENGTHS:

- 1. **Extreme pain point:** \$200k annual costs + 4-person burnout + late-night calls = urgent need^[1]
- 2. **Perfect market fit:** 50+ STR properties = high automation ROI^[3] ^[4]
- 3. **Budget capacity:** Premium Applecross market (\$2.8M median), proven revenue^[5] ^[6]
- 4. **Industry credibility:** Award recognition, regulatory loophole expertise (new STR laws)^[7]
- 5. **Akia/Selene gaps:** Current tools fail on voice, require manual Q&A nightmare
- 6. **Emotional engagement:** Voice agent trial (your voice) = memorable, fun moment with daughter
- 7. **Local connection:** Mum's friend = trust foundation if managed professionally

⚠ CONCERNS:

- 1. **Communication breakdown:** 3 weeks silence despite personal connection
- 2. **Tech literacy gap:** Zapier confusion, no digital maturity
- 3. **Daughter dependency:** Tech decisions bottlenecked through daughter's bandwidth
- 4. **Akia overlap:** Already solving 60-70% of messaging needs at \$89-799/month^[8] ^[9]
- 5. **Selene trial ongoing:** Currently testing competitor (manual Q&A model)
- 6. **Pattern of ghosting:** Consumes advice (reports, web analysis, timeline) → silence
- 7. **Undefined partnership:** "Partner" ambiguous - equity? Revenue share? Handshake?

🚩 RED FLAGS:

- 1. **CRITICAL:** 3 weeks no response despite 2-3 follow-ups + personal tie
- 2. **HIGH:** Free consulting pattern - you've delivered 3+ deliverables, \$0 commitment
- 3. **MEDIUM:** Akia deployment = may perceive voice agent as redundant^[9] ^[8]
- 4. **MEDIUM:** Daughter as gatekeeper adds decision complexity
- 5. **LOW-MEDIUM:** Personal relationship = boundary enforcement risk

Risk Matrix & Mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Communication Failure	High	High	One final touchpoint with 48hr deadline
Competitor Lock-In (Akia/Selene)	Medium	High	Position as Akia complement, not replacement
Tech Adoption Ceiling	Medium	Medium	Offer hands-on onboarding, not DIY
Decision Authority Split	Medium	Medium	Require both owner + daughter in discovery
ROI Perception Gap	Low	High	Lead with time savings, not tech features

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Relationship Boundary Blur	Medium	Medium	Written agreement before ANY work
Opportunity Cost	High	High	Pursue 2-3 alternative pilots in parallel

Strategy & Pitch

▣ Hook:

"Mabel, you're spending \$200k/year and still answering midnight calls. Akia handles texts. We handle the CALLS your guests actually want."

▣ Value Proposition:

1. **Akia Complement Strategy:** Keep Akia for check-ins; add voice layer for high-value interactions
2. **After-Hours Peace:** AI triage + intelligent escalation = sleep through the night
3. **Perth-Based + PRIS Compliant:** Sydney data centres, not US servers^{[2] [10] [11]}
4. **No Manual Q&A:** Self-learning system, not DIY chatbot hell like Selene
5. **Proven by You:** Already tested your voice agent - she laughed, daughter engaged

▣ Pilot Scope (3-Month Test):

- **Duration:** 3 months
- **Scope:** 10 properties (pilot subset)
- **Pricing:** \$750/month (50% pilot discount from standard \$1,500)
- **Use Cases:**
 1. Inbound Guest Inquiries (pre-booking)
 2. After-Hours Emergency Triage
 3. Maintenance Dispatch Coordination
- **Success Metrics:**
 - 40% reduction in Mabel's after-hours phone time
 - 90% guest satisfaction on voice interactions
 - <2min avg response time vs. 4hr current
 - 1+ hour/day time savings (documented)
- **Exit Clause:** Either party cancels with 30 days notice

Next Steps & Timeline

▮ Key Discovery Questions (If Engagement Resumes):

1. What's working well with Akia? What still eats your time?
2. How many late-night calls do you personally handle per week?
3. What happens when a guest calls at 10pm with an emergency?
4. Is Selene meeting your voice automation needs, or are there gaps?
5. Does your daughter have bandwidth to manage tech rollouts, or do you need hands-on support?
6. What would 'success' look like for you in 3 months?
7. Are you waiting on a business plan from us, or something else?
8. Do you want to proceed with a pilot, or are you exploring other options?

▮ Recommended Timeline:

Date	Action
NOW (Oct 27)	Final SMS: "Quick Q - is Selene working, or gaps we should explore?"
Oct 28-29	IF response: Schedule 15min discovery call
Oct 30	IF positive: Send 1-page pilot proposal (NOT full business plan)
Nov 1-3	Decision deadline: Sign pilot agreement or move to alternatives
Nov 4+	IF silence: STOP pursuing. Pivot to 3 alternative Perth STR/trades pilots
Ongoing	Quarterly low-key check-in via mum (no hard sell)

Final Recommendation

▮ **CONDITIONAL PROCEED - WITH STRICT GUARDRAILS**

IF she responds within 48 hours:

- ✓ Execute discovery call → 1-page pilot proposal → signed agreement
- ✓ Require **50% upfront payment** before ANY work begins
- ✓ Hard boundary: No free consulting beyond 1hr discovery

IF silence persists after final touchpoint:

- ▮ **STOP pursuing immediately**
- **Rationale:**
 - 3+ deliverables already provided (reports, web analysis, timeline)
 - Pattern = consume advice, ghost, no commitment
 - Personal connection becomes LIABILITY, not asset

- Better pilots available: Full House, Quest, Perth CBD managers^[12] ^[13]

Why This Matters:

- Your time ROI is **NEGATIVE** (30+ hours invested, \$0 revenue)
- "Mum's friend" doesn't override bad client signals
- Market is competitive: every hour here = lost hour on responsive leads
- **SEA course completion + website launch are HIGHER priority**^[14] ^[2]

Alternative Action:

- ✓ Use Maana Living insights as competitive intel
- ✓ Pitch competitors: "What Maana Living wishes they had"
- ✓ Document learnings for future STR pilot outreach
- ✓ Maintain quarterly relationship via mum (zero pressure)

Bottom Line

Maana Living is a 6.6/10 pilot that becomes:

- **8/10** IF she commits within 48hrs + signs agreement
- **2/10** IF silence continues = immediate STOP loss

DO NOT send full business plan unsolicited.

DO NOT invest more time without commitment.

DO prioritize website launch + responsive pilot alternatives.

Next 7 Days:

1. Send 2-sentence SMS (low-effort engagement test)
2. IF response: Execute discovery → proposal → signature
3. IF silence: Move to Full House, Quest, or 3 alternative targets
4. Finish SEA course requirements
5. **Launch goodai.au website by Nov 1**

Risk-Adjusted Verdict: This is a **SECOND-TIER opportunity**. Don't let personal connection cloud judgment. Treat like any other enterprise sale: **walk away if buying signals disappear**.



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